PP-C-002186A(Army-GL)
June 28, 1985
SUPERSEDING
PP-C-002186(Army-GL)
June 29, 1983

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN SLICES IN GRAVY, THERMOSTABILIZED TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers chicken slices in gravy thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification for

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

United States Standards for Conditions of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Poultry Products Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Regulations Governing the Voluntary Grading of Poultry Products and Rabbit Products and U.S. Classes, Standards, and Grades

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20450.)

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 251 Kearny Street, No. 410, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

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Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

National Academy of Sciences

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall be prepared from chilled or frozen ready-to-cook fowl (mature female chicken) which has been processed in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Poultry Grading Branch Certificate to certify class and condition of the product and either the initial chilling date or initial freezing (in-storage) date.

3.2.1.1 Chilled chicken. Chicken received in the chilled state shall not have been previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 4 days from initial chilling to further processing (see 3.3).

3.2.1.2 Frozen chicken. Raw uncooked chickens received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 0°F for a period of time not to exceed 75 days from initial freezing to further processing (see 3.3).

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3.2.1.3 Chicken, cooked, frozen. Cooked frozen chicken shall be prepared from chilled chicken that complies with 3.2.1 and 3.2.1.1. The chicken shall be processed in accordance with 3.3.1 and 3.3.1.1. The chicken, in either log or slice form, shall be packaged and vacuum-sealed in water impermeable material having an oxygen permeability rate of not more than 10cc of O_2 per square meter per 24 hours per mil thickness at 73°F and 0 percent relative humidity and shall be frozen to 0°F or below within 72 hours. The packaged, frozen cooked chicken shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 30 days prior to tray pack filling (see 3.4).

3.2.2 Celery seed. Ground celery seed shall be prepared from the seed of Apium graveolens L. The ground celery seed shall be light to rich brown in color and possess a characteristic celery odor and flavor with a warm, slightly bitter aftertaste. Volatile oil content shall be not less than 2.0 mL per 100 grams. A minimum of 95 percent by weight, shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 55 sieve.

3.2.3 Chicken broth. Chicken broth may be purchased frozen or canned (thermostabilized). The broth shall be clear, essentially fat free, with percent solids sufficient to comply with the solids requirement in the gravy formulation. The broth shall have a characteristic mild chicken broth odor and flavor and may contain flavor enhancers approved by FDA. The chicken broth shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and, if frozen, shall be held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to gravy formulation.

3.2.4 Starch, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized modified maize food starch for use in canned foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range 140°-170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress and conditions of cold storage. The cooked starch slurry shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.5 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall be Fancy Grade as defined in the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

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3.2.6 Monosodium glutamate. Monosodium glutamate shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.7 Onion powder. Onion powder shall be Fancy Grade as defined in the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.8 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. It shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.9 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, free flowing; white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.2.10 Sodium tripolyphosphate. Sodium tripolyphosphate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.11 Turmeric, ground. Ground turmeric shall be prepared from Curcuma longa L. The ground turmeric shall possess a deep yellow to orange-yellow color with a peppery, aromatic odor. The ground turmeric shall contain not less than 3.5 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground turmeric and shall be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.12 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.13 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and further processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Chicken preparation. The chicken shall be prepared as follows:

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a. The chicken shall be made boneless and skinless. The wing tips, giblets, neck, feet, and viscera shall be excluded. The boned meat shall be free from feathers, skin, blood clots, bruises, blemishes, ligaments, tendons, coarse connective tissue, cartilage and bone greater than 0.3 inch in any dimension. The boneless meat shall be comprised, by weight, of natural proportions of light and dark meat.

b. The boned and trimmed chicken shall be mechanically ground through a kidney-shaped plate having openings of at least 2 inches at the shortest dimension and using a two bladed knife.

c. The chicken meat shall be ground within 24 hours following boning.

3.3.1.1 Chicken log preparation and processing. The chicken logs shall be prepared and processed as follows:

Ingredients	Percent by weight
Chicken meat	95.00
Water	3.69
Salt	0.50
Monosodium glutamate	0.50
Sodium tripolyphosphate	0.25
Pepper, white, ground	0.04
Garlic powder	0.02

a. The coarse ground (chunked) meat shall be mechanically mixed with salt and sodium tripolyphosphate. The mixing shall continue until the mixture exhibits a sticky (tacky) consistency. Time from grinding to mixing shall not exceed four hours.

b. The mixed meat shall immediately be mechanically stuffed tightly into prestuck, regenerated cellulose casings of a size to accommodate the finished product meat dimension requirement. The stuffed meat logs shall be in the cooking process within four hours after being stuffed. (This time period may be extended up to 24 hours, provided the meat logs are maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F.)

c. The meat logs shall be cooked in a cook house (smoke house without smoke) or by other commercially acceptable dry cook method to provide a product meeting the finished product requirements. The cooked logs shall be cooled to 40°F or below within four hours following the cooking process. The cooked, cooled logs shall be held not longer than 48 hours and at a temperature

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not to exceed 40°F after removal from the cooking process and prior to slicing.

d. The cooked meat may be stored in the frozen log form provided the logs are packaged and vacuum-sealed in packaging material complying with requirements specified in 3.2.1.3, within four hours following the cooling process. The logs shall be frozen to 0°F or below within 72 hours of packaging.

e. The cooked meat may be stored in the frozen sliced form provided the logs are sliced to yield eight slices per pound, and the slices packaged and vacuum-sealed in packaging material complying with requirements specified in 3.2.1.3, within four hours following the cooling process. The slices shall be frozen to 0°F or below within 72 hours of packaging.

f. When slicing to filling is a continuous operation, the chicken slices shall be filled into the tray pack cans within four hours of being sliced.

3.4 Gravy preparation. Gravy shall be prepared from the following ingredients:

Ingredients	Percent
Chicken broth 1/	94.32
Corn starch	5.50
Pepper, white, ground	0.05
Onion powder	0.05
Celery seed, ground	0.05
Garlic powder	0.02
Turmeric, ground	0.01

1/ Chicken broth shall be adjusted to between 3.0 and 3.5 percent solids and between 1.0 and 1.5 percent salt.

a. A slurry shall be made with the starch and part of the broth.

b. The remaining ingredients shall be mixed together and heated to not less than 140°F. The starch and flour slurry shall be added and the final mixture heated to between 180° and 190°F, and held for approximately 5 minutes at this temperature.

c. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted to compensate for evaporation loss during heating.

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d. The gravy shall be filled within 4 hours after cooking and held at a temperature of not less than 150°F nor greater than 180°F during this interval.

3.4.1 Chicken slices in gravy preparation. The chicken slices in gravy shall be combined in the following proportions using a two stage filling operation:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Chicken slices	59.0
Gravy	41.0

3.5 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Not less than 40 intact chicken slices shall be shingled in two rows lengthwise into tray pack can and the can filled with gravy.

b. The temperature of the chicken slices at time of filling shall be 28° to 40°F.

c. The temperature of the gravy at time of filling shall be 150°-180°F.

d. Each tray pack can shall be hermetically sealed (under a vacuum of not less than 10 inches of mercury) immediately after filling.

e. Each filled and sealed tray pack can shall be in the retort process within one hour after sealing.

3.6 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 240°F or below in accordance with a scheduled process until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6.0 has been achieved.

3.7 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as but not limited to glass, paint, metal, dirt, insect, insect parts, hair, wood, or paper.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to rancid, burnt, stale, sour, musty or moldy.

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c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The product shall be free of feathers.

e. There shall be no blood clots, bruises, bone, connective tissue, skin, ligaments, tendons, or cartilage measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimensions.

f. There shall be no void areas or air pockets that measure more than 0.5 inch in any dimension.

g. No individual can shall weigh less than 104 ounces.

h. The average net weight shall not be less than 106 ounces.

i. No individual can shall contain less than 62 ounces, drained weight of chicken slices.

j. The average drained weight of chicken slices shall be not less than 64 ounces.

k. Each can shall contain at least 40 approximately 1-3/4 by 4-1/2 inch intact chicken slices.

l. The texture of the slices shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

m. Gravy shall be light tan to dark tan in color.

n. Gravy shall have a smooth (not lumpy) consistency without being excessively thick or thin.

o. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 10.0 percent.

p. The fat content of the product in an individual can shall be not greater than 12.0 percent.

q. The salt content of the product in an individual can shall be not greater than 1.0 percent nor less than 0.5 percent.

r. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened, scorched).

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3.7.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.8 Plant qualification. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Poultry Products Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.9 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be evident by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses or other such supplier-furnished valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. In addition, prior to use, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically, as necessary, to determine

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conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. Results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be heated for 15 minutes in 140° to 150°F water, opened and inspected in accordance with table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0-3200	8		0	2
	8	16	1	2
3201-35000	13		0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

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b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product inspection 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Presence of bone measuring more than 0.3 inch any dimension.
152	Presence of blood clots, bruises, bones, skin, ligaments, tendons, or cartilage measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
153	Fewer than 40 intact (approximately 1-3/4 by 4-1/2 inch) slices in a can.
154	Drained weight of chicken slices in a can is less than 62 ounces. 3/
155	Air pockets or void areas that measure more than 0.5 inch in any dimension.
156	Slice texture dry, rubbery, or mushy.
157	Gravy color not light tan to dark tan.
158	Gravy consistency lumpy or is thick or thin.
159	Product shows evidence of excess heating (materially darkened, scorched).

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insert parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.) foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (To be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee or AMS Poultry Grader.)

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2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS Poultry Grader.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the can shall be poured off and the remaining contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated such as to liquefy rendered fat and to remove the gravy without breaking the chicken slices. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/4-inch sieve in a manner than will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the chicken slices. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted to approximately a 45° angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weights shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4.6.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray packs shall be selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

-Three for laboratory analysis.
-Three for submission to the contractor.
-Three for submission by the inspector as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows. The three unopened tray packs shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three tray packs is greater than 10.0 percent.
b. The fat content in any individual tray pack is greater than 12.0 percent.
c. The salt content in any individual tray pack is less than 0.5 percent or more than 1.0 percent.

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Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserve sample is analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: (1) National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above top edge of box; (4) Length or width of pads less than box dimensions by more than 1/8 inch; (5) Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of the food product, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.5 and 3.6. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated with material suitable for the product. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall

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neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

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5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.7 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Remove from water and open lid for serving.
CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

WARNING: Do not place closed cans in oven, as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

Twenty (20) servings (2 slices with gravy per serving)

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.7.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A469

*U.S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1988—205-038/23380

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
PP-C-002186A(Army-GL)	Chicken Slices in Gravy, Thermostabilized Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 20 Nov 84

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